



# M/J Visual Art 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 6 · FULL YEAR

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

**About this overview.** This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More artworks and projects are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in works studied and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

M/J Visual Art 1 invites sixth graders into the creative process: learning the elements of art, expressing themselves creatively, and exploring art throughout the ages. The course draws inspiration from diverse cultures around the world, the beauty of nature, and the importance of caring for our environment, and it is unapologetically hands-on — most weeks scholars are making something, from cave paintings and mosaics to Matisse-inspired cut-outs, sharing finished work in class galleries along the way.

## THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

### 1 Seeing Like an Artist (Weeks 1–4)

Lists of likes, inspiration webs, a drawing challenge, and cave paintings: art begins with noticing.

### 3 Art Across Cultures (Weeks 9–13)

Farol lanterns and a Hispanic Heritage Month art gallery, monarch butterflies, a mosaics project, and fortune cookies.

### 5 Winter Gallery and Reflection (Weeks 16–18)

A self-assessment, a winter village, and the semester-closing Winter Wonderland gallery.

### 2 The Elements of Art (Weeks 5–8)

Elements of Art I and II, with games, puzzles, and a shape scavenger hunt to make the vocabulary stick.

### 4 Composition and Modern Masters (Weeks 14–15)

Composition studies, non-objective painting, and Henri Matisse-inspired cut-outs.

### 6 Semester 2 (Jan–May)

New projects each week continue the journey through the elements of art, world cultures, artists, and nature.

## A TYPICAL WEEK

- One hands-on art project most weeks — usually just unlined paper and pencil, with any other supplies announced in advance.
- Live class sessions twice a week, with frequent meetups and galleries on Optima's VR campus.
- Seasonal and cultural celebrations woven through the year, from Hispanic Heritage Month to the winter gallery.
- Assignments stay open through the quarter; on-time work earns full credit.

## TIME COMMITMENT

### 250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Project and studio time fill most of the scheduled minutes.
- Gallery weeks close each semester.

## WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A sketchbook (9×12 mixed-media paper), #2 pencils, eraser, and sharpener; colored pencils, markers, basic paint, pastels, air-dry clay, ruler, scissors, and glue are recommended — all dollar-store and craft-store findable.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Access to Optima's VR campus, with the headset charged for VR class days.

**Grading at a glance:** Project Submission 50% · Class Participation 50%

**On-Demand (asynchronous).** Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

**Live school.** Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, with live class sessions twice a week plus VR meetups, on the school's weekly schedule.